

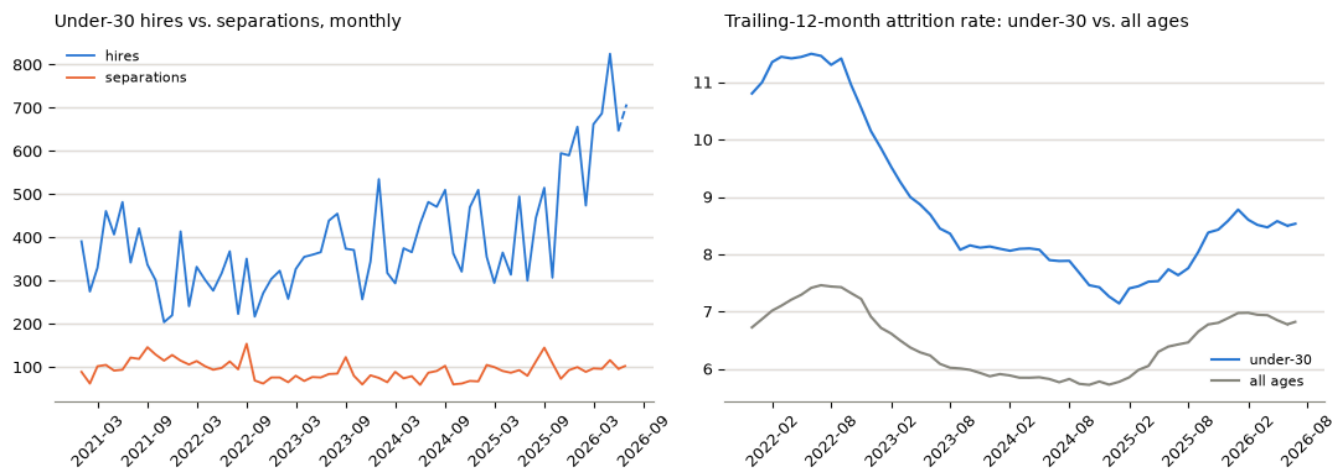
# Under-30 Federal Law Enforcement

One-pager · Source: OPM/EHRI ( [impactproject/opm-ehri-data](#) on HuggingFace) · Full methodology, source screenshots, and monthly detail: [fleo\\_under30.ipynb](#)

## Bottom line

**As of 2026-07, ~16,000 federal law enforcement officers are under 30 (12.8% of ~125,000 total)** -- job series definition (Police, US Marshal, Criminal Investigator, General Investigator, Border Patrol, CBP Officer, Correctional Officer; any pay plan), validated within **7% of BJS's independent census total** and **2% of GAO's independently audited Police-series count** -- the two closest outside checks available. Two other candidate definitions were tested and rejected (missed those same benchmarks by 73% and 78%).

**Year over year:** in the 12 months ending 2026-07 (real trailing data, not a projection), under-30 hiring (~7,112) is up 49% from the same window a year earlier and already 40% above the best full calendar year on record (5,086, 2025). Under-30 **attrition is not elevated**: 8.5% sits well inside its historical range, not at a new high. The one constant: under-30 officers leave at **1.19-1.62x** the all-ages rate, every month checked -- a structural gap, not a new development.



Both external benchmarks (BJS/GAO) are backed by source-report screenshots in [sources/](#) -- see [fleo\\_under30.ipynb](#) §1b. Definitions, validation, monthly detail, and caveats (provisional latest month, no cohort-survival data, etc.) are all there too. Generated 2026-09-14.